

 	Republic of the Philippines Department of Transportation
	Document No: <u>DOTr-HRDD-Forms-004</u> Rev. No.: <u>001</u> Effective Date: <u>03 August 2022</u>
	RE-ENTRY ACTION PLAN (REAP) FORM

INSTRUCTIONS: This form is used in preparing a proposed Re-entry Action Plan in applying to a Scholarship Program. Duly accomplished and signed forms will be submitted to the HRD Division along with the other documentary requirements.

Title of Scholarship Program:	JDS 24th Batch Scholarship Program
Name of the Development Partner	Japan International Cooperation Center through the Department of Economy, Planning, and Development (DEPDev)

I. REAP BACKGROUND AND INFORMATION	
a. REAP Title	Standardization of Railway Track Defect Identification and Corrective Maintenance Procedures in the Philippines
b. REAP Objective	The Re-Entry Action Plan aims to strengthen railway track maintenance practices in the Philippines through the establishment of standardized systems and capacity-building programs. The specific objectives are as follows: 1. Develop a Track Defect Identification System by gathering and analyzing data on railway defects from Philippine railway operators, cross-referenced and validated with international standards, to be completed within 12 months upon return to work in PRI. 2. Formulate a Standard Procedure for Corrective Maintenance based on the identified track defects, incorporating best practices from Philippine railway operators and internationally approved maintenance procedures, to be finalized within 12 months upon return to work in PRI. 3. Integrate the finalized Railway Track Defect Identification System Standard and Corrective Maintenance Procedure into PRI's training programs (curriculum and materials), particularly through the Capacity Development Training (CDT) and Fundamental Training (FT) courses, within 15 months upon return to work. 4. Conduct the training programs (CDT and FT) with the integrated standard, using the designed and prepared training materials, for all railway personnel involved in tracks and guideways maintenance, upon recommendation of the Training Division Head and approval of the program by the PRI Executive Director.
c. Problem/Opportunity	One of the significant issues in the Philippine railway system today is the lack of a unified set of railway operational and maintenance standards. While each railway operator has their own internal procedure and guidelines, there is no unified framework that guides the entire sector in terms of best practices, safety protocols, and operational efficiency. This absence of standardized processes results in a variety of approaches to railway operations and maintenance, which then create inefficiencies, inconsistencies, and even safety risk. Because there is no unified guideline, maintenance procedures vary

	widely among operators, and opportunities for timely repairs are sometimes missed. This leads to delays, reduced operational reliability, and in some cases, safety incidents. For example, issues related to track structure and alignment have been observed in several lines, resulting in service disruptions and even minor derailments. These incidents show how the absence of standardized maintenance practices can directly affect the day-to-day operation of Philippine railways. This issue clearly presents an opportunity for improvement through the establishment of standardized procedures for identifying track defects and conducting corrective maintenance. By developing a comprehensive guideline for railway track inspection and repair, railway operators can ensure that defects are properly identified and addressed through consistent and effective methods, regardless of the railway operator. A unified approach would also allow maintenance data to be consolidated and analyzed more effectively, helping the DOTr, the Rail Sector, and PRI make data driven decision for infrastructure planning and safety monitoring. However, the development of these standards is only part of the solution. While a set of standardized procedures will lay the groundwork for consistency, it is equally important that railway personnel are properly trained to understand and apply these standards effectively. This is where the importance of training comes in. Even the most well-developed standards will not achieve their intended impact if the personnel responsible for implementing them do not fully understand the procedures they are expected to follow. Training serves as an effective medium for communicating the new standards to all relevant railway personnel, from track maintenance crews to track engineers. By providing targeted competency development programs, these personnel will not only become familiar with the guidelines but also learn how to apply them in their daily maintenance activities. This ensures that the standards are not merely written documents but are actively practiced and embedded in actual railway operations.
d. Description in relation to the Department i. Organizational Outcome	1. Policy Evaluation and Formulation The development of a standardized system for identifying railway track defects and implementing corrective maintenance procedures directly addresses the lack of formalized standards in the Philippine railway sector. By establishing clear and uniform maintenance guidelines, the REAP will contribute to policy formulation within the DOTr and Railway Sector. This initiative will help streamline maintenance practices across various railway operators in the Philippines, ensuring that procedures for identifying and repairing track defects are consistent, efficient, and based on both local and international best practices. Formalizing these standards will also align railway operations with established safety and quality requirements, which are essential for improving overall service reliability and minimizing operational risks. 2. System Development Beyond policy formulation, the REAP emphasizes the creation of a structured system for railway track defect identification and corrective maintenance. This system integrates local experiences with

	personnel can effectively apply these procedures. Ultimately, these competencies will enable me to lead initiatives that enhance the safety, reliability, and efficiency of the Philippine railway system.
e. Relation to the Government's Development Plan	This REAP supports the Philippine Development Plan (PDP) 2023–2028, which operationalizes the AmBisyon Natin 2040 vision of a “matatag, maginhawa, at panatag na buhay para sa lahat.” In Chapter 8: Advance Research & Development, Technology, and Innovation, the REAP's research-based methodology strengthens both Outcome 1: basic R&D and knowledge creation, and Outcome 2: market-driven, customer-centered research and development. Collecting localized railway data ensures evidence-based standards tailored to the Philippine context. Under Chapter 12: Expand and Upgrade Infrastructure, the REAP's focus on developing standardized maintenance procedures supports Outcome 2: seamless and inclusive connectivity through local and international linkages. Consistent safety and reliability in railway operations enhance infrastructure performance in line with national goals In Chapter 2: Promote Human and Social Development, specifically Subchapter 2.2 on Education and Lifelong Learning, the REAP's competency development initiatives equip railway personnel to implement these standards effectively, supporting Outcome 3: improved governance for human capital development. In addition to the PDP, the REAP contributes to achieving Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) 9, 11, and 8. SDG 9: Industry, Innovation, and Infrastructure – <i>Build resilient infrastructure, promote inclusive and sustainable industrialization and foster innovation.</i> Developing a standardized track defect identification system and corrective maintenance procedures enhances infrastructure resilience and sustainability in the railway sector. SDG 11: Sustainable Cities and Communities – <i>Make cities and human settlements inclusive, safe, resilient, and sustainable.</i> By improving railway maintenance standards, the REAP enhances the safety, reliability, and efficiency of rail transport systems, contributing to a safer, more sustainable urban transport options. SDG 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth – <i>Promote sustained, inclusive, and sustainable economic growth, full and productive employment, and decent work for all.</i> The creation of training materials and delivery of training courses empower railway personnel by providing them with updated skills and knowledge for safe and efficient maintenance practices, supporting decent work and economic stability.
f. Direct Beneficiary	The immediate beneficiaries of this REAP are railway personnel, specifically those involved in train operations and railway maintenance. This includes engineers, technicians, workers, train operators, and other staff working on tracks at Philippine National Railways (PNR), Light Rail Transit Authority (LRTA), Light Rail Manila Corporation (LRMC), Metro Rail Transit – Line 3 (DOTr-MRT3), as well as upcoming railway lines. Additionally, employees from private contractors who provide external services related to track repairs for railway operators will also benefit.



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According to PRI's records, a total of 1,992 railway personnel have completed the Refresher Training Course or the Fundamental Training Course under the Commercial Train Driving, Tracks and Guideways Maintenance, and Railway Maintenance competencies (as of this writing). These individuals are expected to directly benefit from the REAP. Apart from the current pool of railway personnel, those who intend to join the railway workforce will also benefit from the REAP.

The REAP provides updated, standardized knowledge on track defect identification and corrective maintenance procedures. This will improve the efficiency, safety, and reliability of the railway system, enhancing service delivery and operational standards nationwide. By equipping railway personnel with the necessary skills and competencies, the REAP will foster a more skilled, confident, and professional workforce, contributing to a safer, more dependable railway network and supporting the broader goals of Philippine railway modernization.

g. Gender Equality, Disability, and Social Inclusion (GEDSI)

According to the Philippine Statistics Authority's Public Transport Accessibility and Safety Report, railway transport is the mode of public transport chosen by the marginalized sector of passenger. These passengers include persons with disabilities (PWD), senior citizen, pregnant women, and other priority passenger. True enough, rail transport offers better accessibility and safety to these passengers.

In recognition of their needs, railway operators prioritized their and safety and comfort. The first car in the train is dedicated to them, with the first two doors specifically designated for PWDs, senior citizens, and pregnant women. The remaining doors of the first car are assigned to women passengers.

However, the safety of these passengers remains vulnerable to risks posed by track defects and inadequate maintenance. By establishing standardized procedures for track defect identification and corrective maintenance, this REAP ensures that railway systems operate safely and reliably for all users.

While the REAP does not directly implement gender- or group-specific interventions, it intentionally supports inclusivity by improving railway safety and reliability, factors that disproportionately affect women, PWDs, senior citizens, and pregnant passengers who rely on public transport for accessible and secure mobility. Through these systemic improvements, the REAP contributes to building a more inclusive and equitable transport system.

h. Output	This REAP will generate two key outputs that directly support the improvement of railway safety and maintenance practices in the Philippines. 1. Standards on Railway Track Defect Identification and Corrective Maintenance Procedures. This output will establish a uniform framework for identifying, classifying, and repairing track defects across railway operators. By aligning these procedures with international best practices, the standards will promote safe, efficient, and reliable railway operations. This will support the Department of Transportation's mission to provide transportation systems that are efficient, secure, and globally competitive. Standardized procedures will also minimize inconsistencies in maintenance practices, reduce safety risks, and improve long-term infrastructure sustainability. 2. Enhanced PRI Training Courses (Capacity Development Training (CDT) Course and Fundamental Training (FT) Course) through the integration of the developed Standard. To ensure effective implementation, a dedicated training course will be developed and delivered through the Philippine Railway Institute. This course will equip railway maintenance personnel with the technical knowledge and practical skills needed to apply the standards consistently. The training supports PRI's mandate to enhance human resource capability within the railway sector and ensures that safety and maintenance protocols are understood and followed across different operating agencies.
II. REAP TIMELINE AND IMPLEMENTATION	
a. Measurability	The success of the REAP will be monitored according to the progress and implementation of its two major outputs. Output 1: Standards on Railway Track Defect Identification and Corrective Maintenance Procedures Milestones: - Months 1-6: Completion of data gathering, benchmarking, and analysis with Philippine railway operators, including alignment with international standards. - Months 7-12: Submission of the draft standard for stakeholder review, consultation, and revision. - Month 13 onward: Final approval and issuance of the standard by the Department of Transportation (DOTr). Success Indicators: - Adoption of the standard across railway operators. - Results of periodic audits and compliance assessments showing uniform application of the procedures. - Reduction in repeat or unaddressed track defects over time. Output 2: Enhanced PRI Training Programs (CDT and FT Courses) through integration of the developed standard Milestones: - Within 3 months after standard approval: Development and

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	finalization of the training programs. • Within 1 month after training programs approval: Rollout of the enhance training program to relevant railway personnel (CDT) and future railway personnel (FT). Success Indicators: • Completion of training sessions with satisfactory participant evaluation results. • Submission of participant Re-Entry Action Plans (REAPs) detailing how the standard will be applied in their workplace. • Post-training audits conducted by PRI's Research and Development Division confirming implementation of these action plans within railway organizations.	
b. Sustainability	The Standards for Railway Track Defect Identification and Corrective Maintenance Procedure will be issued as an official policy, allowing it to be integrated into the regulatory framework of the Department of Transportation (DOTr) and the internal operating procedures of railway operators. Embedding the standard at this level ensures that its implementation is mandatory, long-term, and consistently applied across all affected railway systems. The corresponding enhanced training programs will be incorporated into the regular training offerings of the Philippine Railways Institute (PRI). By including the course in PRI's standard training pool, railway personnel will continually receive structured instruction on the new procedures, supporting sustained competency development across the workforce. To ensure ongoing relevance, both the policy and the training program will be subject to periodic review. Any revisions or updates to the standard will be reflected in the training programs, ensuring alignment between regulatory expectations and actual field practice. Through this mechanism of continuous updating and retraining, the gains of the REAP will be institutionalized, sustained, and adapted to evolving operational contexts.	
c. Predictive Action Steps with Identified Success Indicators		
i. Phase/Stage	ii. Expected Output	iii. Timeline
• Data Gathering and Analysis	• Collated data of track defects and maintenance procedures	• 6 months



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international benchmarks and provides a consistent framework for recording, classifying, analyzing, and addressing track defects across different railway operators. It will also serve as a decision-support tool for prioritizing maintenance activities, scheduling repairs, and monitoring the effectiveness of corrective measures. By introducing a uniform and data-driven process, the REAP will promote efficiency, enhance coordination among operators, and foster accountability in track maintenance management. The system's establishment will institutionalize a more proactive and evidence-based approach to railway infrastructure maintenance in the Philippines

3. Building Competencies

In addition to improving policies and systems, the REAP will strengthen the competencies of railway personnel in track defect identification and corrective maintenance. Through the Philippine PRI, targeted training materials and competency development programs will be developed and implemented to ensure that maintenance personnel fully understand and apply the newly formulated standards. By equipping the workforce with the necessary technical knowledge and practical skills, the REAP will help build a more competent, confident, and professional maintenance team. This improvement in human capacity is vital for sustaining the application of standardized procedures and for enhancing the overall safety, reliability, and efficiency of railway operations.

ii. Target Competency Improvement

The main objective of the JDS Program is to strengthen the government's administrative capacities through postgraduate education that enhances the ability to formulate and implement social and economic development plans. This objective aligns closely with the outcomes of my REAP, which focuses on developing standardized systems and building competencies in railway maintenance.

Under the program's component on the *Promotion of Infrastructure Improvement and Development and/or Enhancement of Disaster Risk Reduction/Management*, I expect to gain advanced competencies in policy analysis, infrastructure management, and data-driven decision-making. These skills will enable me to evaluate existing maintenance frameworks and formulate standardized, evidence-based policies for track defect identification and corrective maintenance. Such competencies are essential for establishing consistent and efficient practices that align with both local conditions and international railway standards.

Moreover, the program's focus on organizational and human resource development will equip me with the capacity to design and implement targeted training programs. This will allow me to translate technical standards into practical learning modules, ensuring that railway



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5. Printing of Training Materials (Handouts of 200 copies)

For the CDT Course (New Course Offering)

- Cost: Php 50,000
 - Handout Materials (Papers, Ring Binds, Vellum Boards): Php 15,000
 - Printing Cost: Php 20,000
 - Ring Binding Cost: Php 10,000
- Funding Source: Internal Fund to be allocated from PRI's budget on Training Planning and Design

For the FT Course

- Cost: No Additional Cost (FT Course Textbook budget allocation is part of the overhead cost for the FT Course)
- Funding Source: N/A

6. Training Delivery

Conduct of the enhanced training programs (includes food and refreshment for the participants)

For the CDT Course (New Course Offering)

- Cost: Php 151,000
 - Food and Refreshments: $\text{Php } 30,000 \times 4 \text{ Batches} = \text{Php } 120,000$
 - Training Kit: Php 26,000
 - Pen: $\text{Php } 10 \times 200 \text{ participants} = \text{Php } 2000$
 - Stationeries: $\text{Php } 15 \times 200 \text{ participants} = \text{Php } 3000$
 - Name Plates: $\text{Php } 30 \times 200 \text{ participants} = \text{Php } 6000$
 - Trainee ID: $\text{Php } 50 \times 200 \text{ participants} = \text{Php } 10,000$
 - Envelopes: $\text{Php } 25 \times 200 \text{ participants} = \text{Php } 5000$
 -
 - Examination Materials: Php 5000
- Funding Source: Internal Fund to be allocated from PRI's budget on Training Delivery

For the FT Course

- Cost: No additional cost (FT Course budget allocation will part of the overhead cost for FT Training Delivery)
- Funding Source: N/A

7. Monitoring and Evaluation

Conduct of Audits and Assessment on the implementation of CDT Course trainee's re-entry action plans.

- Cost: No Cost (Overhead cost as part of the function of RDD personnel)
- Funding Source: N/A

- Standards Drafting, Development, and Stakeholder's Review - Final Revision and Adoption of the Standards - Training Material Design - Training Delivery - Monitoring and Evaluation	- Drafted, reviewed, and revised standards - Final and signed Standards - Training curriculum and training materials (PPT and Handouts) - Trained Railway Personnel - Audit Reports	- Within 6 months after data gathering - Within 1 month after final revision - Within 3 months after the final approval of the Standards - Within 1 month after approval of training curriculum and materials 6 months after the rollout of the initial training
d. Target Date to Start	After JDS Program (Estimate November 2028)	
e. Target Date to End	December 2030	

III. RESOURCES

1. Data Gathering and Analysis

Data collection and Consultation Meetings with Railway Operators

- Cost: Php 20,000
 - Meals and Refreshments: Php 15,000
 - Logistics and Materials: Php 3,000
 - Transportation Cost: Php 2,000
- Funding Source: Internal Fund to be allocated to from PRI's budget on Research and Development and Policy Formulation

2. Standard Drafting and Development

Drafting and Meetings (Draft Review Sessions with TWG/Railway Operators/Stakeholders)

- Cost: Php 20,000
 - Meals and Refreshments: Php 15,000
 - Logistics and Materials: Php 3,000
 - Transportation Cost: Php 2,000
- Funding Source: Internal Fund to be allocated from PRI's budget on Research and Development and Policy Formulation

3. Final Revision and Adoption of the Standards

Printing, Signing, and Publication of the approved final revision of the standard

- Cost: No Cost (Overhead cost)
- Funding Source: N/A

4. Training Material Development

Development of Training Program for the CDT and FT (Powerpoint Presentations)

- Cost: No Cost (Overhead Cost as this is part of my function as a Training Specialist III)
- Funding Source: N/A

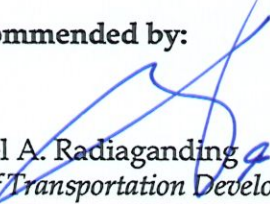
IV. COMMENT(S) AND RECOMMENDATION(S)	
a. Immediate Superior (Mentor)	
b. Head of the Office/Division/Service	
c. Human Resource Development Division	

Prepared by:


 Mariol Miguel R. Bactad
Training Specialist III

 Name of Applicant with signature

Recommended by:


 Israel A. Radiaganding
Chief Transportation Development Officer - Training Division

 Immediate Supervisor with signature (Mentor)

Approved and noted by:


 Anneli R. Lontoc, CESO I
Undersecretary and Acting Executive Director
Philippine Railways Institute

 Head of the Office/Division/Service with signature